



Because You Matter Student-Athlete Gratitude Journal

By Lornette Daye

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Introduction from Lornette Daye

Welcome to the Finish Strong series.

As a former elite sprinter, Canadian National Team athlete, and coach, I know exactly what it feels like to stand on the starting line with the weight of the world on your shoulders. I know the sting of setbacks, the grind of daily discipline, and the pressure to perform.

But I also know the power of resilience, faith, and mental fortitude.

These materials are designed for you—the student-athlete who is navigating the complexities of sports, academics, and life. Over the course of this journey, we will focus on building your identity, courage, and purpose beyond the scoreboard. My message to you is simple: no matter how the race begins, you have the power to Finish Strong.

Take time to reflect, prepare, and grow. You are more than an athlete.

Finish Strong,

Lornette Daye

How to Use This Journal

Gratitude is a muscle. The more you train it, the stronger it gets. Over the next 90 days, use these pages to anchor yourself in the present, release what you cannot control, and intentionally design your day. Remember: Because you matter.

Day 1

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 2

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 3

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 4

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 5

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 6

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 7

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Week 1 Reflection

What was the biggest win of the week?

What challenged me, and how did I handle it?

What am I looking forward to next week?

Day 8

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 9

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 10

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 11

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 12

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 13

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 14

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Week 2 Reflection

What was the biggest win of the week?

What challenged me, and how did I handle it?

What am I looking forward to next week?

Day 15

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 16

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 17

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 18

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 19

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 20

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 21

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Week 3 Reflection

What was the biggest win of the week?

What challenged me, and how did I handle it?

What am I looking forward to next week?

Day 22

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 23

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 24

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 25

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 26

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 27

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 28

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Week 4 Reflection

What was the biggest win of the week?

What challenged me, and how did I handle it?

What am I looking forward to next week?

Day 29

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 30

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 31

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 32

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 33

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 34

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 35

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Week 5 Reflection

What was the biggest win of the week?

What challenged me, and how did I handle it?

What am I looking forward to next week?

Day 36

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 37

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 38

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 39

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 40

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 41

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 42

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Week 6 Reflection

What was the biggest win of the week?

What challenged me, and how did I handle it?

What am I looking forward to next week?

Day 43

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 44

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 45

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 46

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 47

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 48

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 49

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Week 7 Reflection

What was the biggest win of the week?

What challenged me, and how did I handle it?

What am I looking forward to next week?

Day 50

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 51

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 52

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 53

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 54

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 55

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 56

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Week 8 Reflection

What was the biggest win of the week?

What challenged me, and how did I handle it?

What am I looking forward to next week?

Day 57

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 58

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 59

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 60

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 61

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 62

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 63

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Week 9 Reflection

What was the biggest win of the week?

What challenged me, and how did I handle it?

What am I looking forward to next week?

Day 64

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 65

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 66

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 67

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 68

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 69

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 70

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Week 10 Reflection

What was the biggest win of the week?

What challenged me, and how did I handle it?

What am I looking forward to next week?

Day 71

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 72

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 73

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 74

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 75

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 76

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 77

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Week 11 Reflection

What was the biggest win of the week?

What challenged me, and how did I handle it?

What am I looking forward to next week?

Day 78

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 79

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 80

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 81

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 82

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 83

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 84

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Week 12 Reflection

What was the biggest win of the week?

What challenged me, and how did I handle it?

What am I looking forward to next week?

Day 85

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 86

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 87

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 88

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 89

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Day 90

Date: _____

Today I am grateful for:

Today I release (what is out of my control):

Today I choose:

One way I will show discipline today:

One person I can encourage:

One step toward my future:

Closing Encouragement

You have completed this portion of the Finish Strong journey!

Remember that the lessons you've learned are not just for your sport; they are for your life. The resilience, discipline, and faith you are building now will carry you through every transition, every challenge, and every victory that lies ahead.

Keep building your identity. Keep finding your courage. Keep finishing strong.

Contact Information:

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